

Chedam — Reality Check and Retail Gap List

Oct 2, 2026 · @sreya brahma teja

Chedam's offline, own-your-hardware design holds up for stock, staff and back-office work, but it breaks in three places real stores depend on: card payments, remote access for owners, and who fixes it when it fails. The gap tables below have a **Decision** column for you to mark each item Add, Later or Skip.

1. Verdict

The plan is strong where the work stays inside the shop, and weak wherever money or people outside the shop are involved.

Area	Holds up in real stores?	Why
Selling at the till, cash	Yes	Offline queue, hub ordering, receipts all work without internet
Inventory, packs, receiving, expiry	Yes	A real strength over many cheap POS apps, especially for perishables
Staff messages, pings, time sheets	Yes	LAN-only is fine for people in the building
Card and debit payments	No, not offline	Every card payment in Canada is approved online by the bank; a standalone terminal means typing every amount twice
Owner checking sales from home	No	No internet = no remote view; owners expect this from Square/Shopify
Off-site backup	Weak	A fire or break-in takes the hub and the USB backup together
Delivery apps	Partial	Manual entry works but staff skip it during rushes
Payroll	Partial	Deductions, ROEs and T4s are legally heavy; mistakes carry penalties
Support and repairs	Missing	When a Pi fails at 6 pm Saturday, someone must fix it — today that is you

Area	Holds up in real stores?	Why
Phones with the camera	Fragile	Installing a local security certificate on staff phones is hard for non-technical owners

Bottom line: "no internet" should become "works without internet; uses it when available." Card payments, remote view, off-site backup and updates all need an optional internet link.

2. Real-life scenarios where Chedam falls short

Each scenario is something a small store owner meets in the first months. Severity: High = loses money or customers; Medium = daily friction; Low = occasional.

#	Scenario	What happens with the current spec	Severity	Fix option
1	Saturday rush, most customers pay by card	Cashier types each total into a separate terminal; typos cause over/under-charges; card totals don't reconcile per sale	High	Integrate a payment terminal (needs internet); see Section 4
2	Internet is down	Card terminal can't approve anyway; store becomes cash-only regardless of POS	High	Show "cash only" mode clearly; terminals with offline/store-and-forward where the processor allows
3	Owner on holiday wants today's sales	No way to see it outside the shop	High	Optional remote view: hub sends a daily summary or a secure read-only link when online
4	Break-in: hub and USB stolen	All data lost since the last time the USB went home	High	Encrypted off-site backup (owner's own cloud drive or a second USB rotated weekly)

#	Scenario	What happens with the current spec	Severity	Fix option
5	Pi SD card dies on Friday evening	Tills keep selling offline, but no new devices, reports or stock sync until someone restores	High	Pre-loaded spare card in the box; 10-minute restore guide; remote support
6	New staff phone can't open the camera	Browser blocks camera without trusted HTTPS; certificate install on iPhone needs several Settings screens	Medium	Use a real domain certificate for the hub (renews with brief internet), or a guided installer
7	Customer buys 0.742 kg of mangoes	Weight typed by hand; a scale used to price goods must be approved by Measurement Canada	Medium	Integrate a certified POS scale; PLU codes for produce
8	Cash total \$12.33	Canada has no penny; cash totals must round to 5¢	Medium	Cash rounding rule (card stays exact)
9	Customer returns pop bottles	BC container deposits and eco fees are not modelled	Medium	Deposit and fee lines attached to products
10	Teen buys a vape or lottery ticket	No age check prompt	Medium	Age-restricted flag with mandatory "ID checked" step
11	Employee quits mid-month	Spec has no Record of Employment; owner must file it with Service Canada	Medium	ROE data export; recommend payroll service integration
12	Accountant asks for GST/PST return figures	Reports exist but not shaped as GST34/PST returns	Medium	Tax return reports per filing period
13	Owner wants a 2-for-\$5 promotion	Only line/cart discounts exist	Medium	Promotions engine (Section 5)
14	Regular customer asks for loyalty points	Not in spec	Medium	Customer profiles + points (Section 7)

#	Scenario	What happens with the current spec	Severity	Fix option
15	Delivery orders during lunch rush	Staff skip manual entry; stock drifts	Medium	Snap-the-ticket, end-of-day platform report import
16	Second store opens	One-hub design has no inter-store sync	Medium	Multi-location sync over internet (later)
17	Hub software 18 months old	No internet = no security or tax-rate updates	Medium	Auto-update when online; USB update as fallback
18	Owner forgets password and recovery code	Locked out of own data	Medium	Recovery via support with identity check; printed recovery sheet at install
19	Staff trains on live till	Practice sales mix with real sales	Low	Training mode
20	3 tills + reports at closing on Pi Zero	Slow screens on 512 MB	Low	Production hub Pi 4/5; heavy reports in browser

3. Go-to-market reality

"Replace subscriptions" is a weaker pitch than it sounds: the biggest competitors already charge \$0 per month for basic POS and make their money on card fees. Chedam wins on ownership, perishables depth and working without internet, not on price alone.

What owners compare you with

Competitor	Monthly software	How they earn	Works offline?	Where Chedam can beat it
Square (Canada)	\$0 basic plan; paid tiers	Card fees: 2.5% credit in person, Interac contactless 0.75% + 7¢ (PayDaddy)	Terminal has an offline mode	Perishables, lots and expiry, no data lock-in, staff tools

Competitor	Monthly software	How they earn	Works offline?	Where Chedam can beat it
Loyverse	\$0 core POS; add-ons \$25/store for employees, \$25 for advanced inventory, \$5 for full history (POSUSA)	Add-ons, payments	Keeps selling offline, syncs later	All modules included, no per-store add-ons, hub owned by the store
Shopify POS, Lightspeed, Clover	Paid monthly plans	Subscriptions + card fees	Limited	No monthly fee, data stays in the shop

What the strategy must answer before selling

1. **Payments:** owners will not give up integrated card payments. Partner with a Canadian processor (e.g. Helcim, Moneris, Global Payments, Stripe Terminal) or keep the terminal standalone and accept slower checkout.
2. **Support:** who answers the phone when the till won't print? Free software with no support loses to Square's support line. Decide: paid support plan, per-visit fee, or a local partner network.
3. **Your income:** if the software is free and there is no subscription, revenue must come from hardware kits, installation, support plans, premium AI tier, or a processing partnership (processors pay POS partners a share of fees).
4. **Liability:** a lost sale history or wrong tax total is your problem as the supplier. You need terms of service, a warranty statement, and business insurance (errors & omissions).
5. **Proof:** run one real pilot (Amramphalam or a friendly shop) for at least 2 months before selling; real stores reveal problems specs cannot.
6. **Switching cost:** owners switch POS rarely. The import tool, a done-for-you setup, and a parallel-run week (old and new side by side) lower the fear.

Honest positioning

"Your POS, your data, your hardware. No monthly fee. Keeps selling when the internet is down. Built for stores that sell perishables."

4. Gap list A: checkout and payments

These are the items a cashier or customer notices first. "Offline?" says whether the feature works without internet; "Phase" is my suggested placement in the v0.1 roadmap.

Feature	What stores expect	Offline?	Phase	Decision
Integrated card/debit terminal	Total sent to terminal, approval returns to the sale automatically	No — needs internet	1 (via processor partner)	▼
Cash rounding to 5¢	Cash totals round to nearest 5¢; card stays exact	Yes	1	▼
Split payments	Part cash, part card, part gift card on one sale	Yes	1	▼
Price override with reason	Cashier changes a price; manager PIN above a limit	Yes	1	▼
No-sale drawer open log	Every drawer open without a sale recorded	Yes	1	▼
Training mode	Practice sales that never touch stock or reports	Yes	1	▼
Tax-exempt sales	First Nations exemption (status card number), PST resale exemption, wholesale	Yes	1	▼
Hold a sale and recall on another till	Customer forgot wallet; resume elsewhere	Yes	1	▼
Customer-facing display	Second screen showing items, total, promotions	Yes	2	▼
Gift cards	Sell, redeem, check balance, printed or barcode cards	Yes	3	▼
Store credit and house accounts	Regulars or businesses pay at month end; statements	Yes	3	▼
Layaway and special orders	Deposit now, collect or order-in later	Yes	3	▼

Feature	What stores expect	Offline?	Phase	Decision
Quotes / estimates	Quote converted into a sale or invoice	Yes	3	▼
Foreign cash (USD)	Accept USD at a set rate, give change in CAD	Yes	3	▼
Email / SMS receipts	Paperless receipt and digital return proof	No — needs internet	Later	▼

5. Gap list B: products, pricing and promotions

Pricing tools are where small stores make or lose margin; most are missing from v0.1.

Feature	What stores expect	Offline?	Phase	Decision
Promotions engine	Buy-one-get-one, mix and match, 2 for \$5, % off category, happy-hour times	Yes	2	▼
Coupons and discount codes	Printed or scanned coupons, limits per customer	Yes	2	▼
Scheduled price changes	Sale price with start and end date; switches automatically	Yes	1	▼
Near-expiry markdown	Auto-suggest 30–50% off items expiring in 1–2 days; markdown labels	Yes	1	▼
Shelf labels and price tags	Print labels; "reprint list" after price changes	Yes	1	▼
Produce PLU codes + certified scale	Type 4011 for bananas; weight from a Measurement Canada-approved scale	Yes	1	▼
Container deposits and eco fees	BC beverage deposits, environmental handling fees added per item; deposit refunds	Yes	1	▼
Age-restricted products	Tobacco, vaping, lottery, alcohol: mandatory "ID checked" step, logged	Yes	1	▼

Feature	What stores expect	Offline?	Phase	Decision
Product images on till	Photo buttons for items without barcodes (bakery, produce)	Yes	1	▼
Variants matrix	Size × colour for clothing and shoes, one parent product	Yes	3	▼
Bundles and kits	Gift hamper made of several stocked items	Yes	3	▼
Serial / IMEI tracking	Electronics: serial captured at sale, warranty lookup	Yes	Later	▼

6. Gap list C: inventory and food safety

Inventory is already Chedam's strongest area; these additions cover food-safety duties and growth to more than one location.

Feature	What stores expect	Offline?	Phase	Decision
Cooler and freezer temperature log	Staff record fridge temperatures twice a day; alerts when out of range; inspector-ready report	Yes	2	▼
Wireless temperature sensors	Cheap sensors report to the hub automatically	Yes (LAN)	Later	▼
Product recall trace	Find which lots were sold and when; block sale of recalled lots	Yes	3	▼
Shrink / loss report	Theft, damage, expiry, admin errors by reason and value	Yes	1	▼
Cycle counts with phone scanner	Count one aisle a day; variances explained	Yes	1	▼
Min/max auto purchase orders	Draft POs when stock falls below minimum	Yes	3	▼
Consignment stock	Vendor owns stock until sold; pay vendor on sale	Yes	Later	▼

Feature	What stores expect	Offline?	Phase	Decision
Multi-location and transfers	Second store or warehouse; move stock between them	Needs internet between sites	Later	▼
Bilingual product labels	English/French names for imported pre-packaged food labels	Yes	3	▼
Supplier price lists import	Load a vendor's full price list; compare vendors	Yes	3	▼

7. Gap list D: customers and marketing

Customer retention and a feedback portal are in the Chedam project goals but not yet in the spec; most outreach (email, SMS, online store) needs internet.

Feature	What stores expect	Offline?	Phase	Decision
Customer profiles	Name, phone, purchase history, notes; find by phone at the till	Yes	1	▼
Loyalty points / punch cards	Earn per \$ spent, redeem as discount; "10th coffee free"	Yes	2	▼
Feedback portal	QR code on receipt; customer rates the visit on their phone	Needs internet (or in-store tablet)	3	▼
Marketing consent (CASL)	Record who agreed to emails/SMS and when; unsubscribe	Yes	2	▼
Email / SMS campaigns	Promotions to opted-in customers	No — needs internet	Later	▼
Online store / click and collect	Customers order online, pick up in store; stock synced	No — needs internet	Later	▼
Google Business Profile hours and products	Show stock and hours on Google	No — needs internet	Later	▼

Feature	What stores expect	Offline?	Phase	Decision
Customer pre-orders and reminders	"Your mangoes arrived" notification for reserved items	Needs internet for SMS	3	▼

8. Gap list E: staff, security and operations

These cover the daily running of the store and loss prevention, which owners care about as much as sales.

Feature	What stores expect	Offline?	Phase	Decision
Opening and closing checklists	Lights, alarm, cooler check, till count — ticked per shift	Yes	2	▼
Shift handover notes	Outgoing shift leaves notes for the next	Yes	2	▼
Loss-prevention report	Voids, refunds, no-sales, discounts and overrides per cashier, with unusual patterns flagged	Yes	1	▼
CCTV timestamp link	Each sale shows its time so it can be found on camera footage; optional camera snapshot on refunds	Yes (LAN)	Later	▼
Staff discount rules	Employee discount with limits, logged	Yes	1	▼
Sales by employee / commissions	Sales and commission per person	Yes	3	▼
Break and overtime alerts	BC rules: meal break after 5 hours; overtime warnings before they happen	Yes	4	▼
Licence and permit reminders	Business licence, food permit, insurance renewals with expiry alerts	Yes	2	▼
Equipment maintenance log	Fridge service, scale certification, printer repairs	Yes	Later	▼

Feature	What stores expect	Offline?	Phase	Decision
Multi-language interface	Hindi, Punjabi, Chinese, French options for staff	Yes	Later	▼
Accessibility	Large text, high contrast, screen-reader labels	Yes	1	▼

9. Gap list F: finance, reporting and compliance

Compliance items are not optional for a store that uses Chedam; a missing one becomes the owner's problem with CRA or the province, and then yours.

Feature	What stores expect	Offline?	Phase	Decision
GST/HST receipt rules	Under \$100: business name, date, total. \$100–\$499.99: add GST/HST number and tax shown or "tax included" with rate. \$500+: add customer name, terms and item description (MapleInvoice)	Yes	1	▼
GST and PST return reports	Figures laid out for the GST/HST return and BC PST return per filing period	Yes	4	▼
6-year record retention	Sales, receipts and payroll kept at least 6 years; deletion blocked inside that window	Yes	1	▼
Record of Employment (ROE) data	Hours and earnings ready for Service Canada when someone leaves	Yes (filing needs internet)	4	▼
T4 slips and summary data	Year-end employee totals for filing	Yes (filing needs internet)	4	▼
Payroll service connection	Hand off pay runs to a payroll provider instead of calculating deductions in Chedam	No — needs internet	Later	▼

Feature	What stores expect	Offline?	Phase	Decision
Petty cash	Small cash spends from a float, with receipts	Yes	3	▼
Bank deposit tracking	Cash taken from tills to the bank, matched on the statement	Yes	4	▼
Card processing fee tracking	Fees per card type, shown in margin and P&L	Yes	4	▼
Financial statements	Profit & loss, balance sheet, cash flow for the owner and lender	Yes	4	▼
Sales insights	Sales by hour/day heatmap, best and worst sellers, sell-through, year-over-year	Yes	2	▼
End-of-day report by email	Owner gets the Z-report summary on their phone each night	Needs internet	2	▼

The 6-year retention rule and receipt thresholds should be confirmed with an accountant before launch; thresholds were raised in a 2024 amendment, so older guides show different numbers.

10. Gap list G: the product business around Chedam

These are not app features; they are what a store owner expects from whoever sells them a POS. Without them, a working app still loses to Square.

Item	What owners expect	Needs internet?	When	Decision
Support line and hours	Phone/WhatsApp help, at least during store hours	—	Before launch	▼
Remote support access	You can see the hub's health and help without driving there (owner switches it on)	Yes, on request	Before launch	▼
Ready-to-plug hardware kit	Pre-configured hub, router settings, printer, scanner in one box	—	Before launch	▼

Item	What owners expect	Needs internet?	When	Decision
Installation and data move service	You set it up and import their old data	—	Before launch	▼
Swap-and-replace hardware warranty	Spare hub mailed or delivered next day	—	Before launch	▼
Off-site encrypted backup	Optional nightly copy to the owner's own cloud drive	Yes	Phase 0	▼
Automatic updates when online	Security, tax-rate and dataset updates without a USB visit	Yes	Phase 0	▼
Built-in help and training videos	Short how-to clips stored on the hub; staff can learn offline	No	Phase 2	▼
Terms of service, privacy policy, warranty	Clear limits on liability and data ownership	—	Before launch	▼
Business registration and insurance	Incorporated entity, errors and omissions insurance	—	Before launch	▼
Pricing model	Free core + paid support / hardware / premium AI / processing partnership	—	Before launch	▼

11. Recommended must-haves before going to market

If only ten items are added, these are the ones a store will refuse to switch without. My suggestion, for you to confirm in the tables above:

1. **Integrated card payments** through a Canadian processor partner (and a clear cash-only mode when offline).
2. **Cash rounding, GST/HST receipt rules and tax-exempt sales** — legal basics at the till.
3. **Promotions and scheduled sale prices** — every store runs deals.
4. **Near-expiry markdowns and shelf labels** — your perishables edge, made visible.
5. **Certified scale and produce PLU codes** — required for selling by weight.
6. **Customer profiles with simple loyalty** — retention is a stated project goal.
7. **Loss-prevention report and training mode** — owners' top worry after sales.

8. **Off-site backup and auto-updates when online** — protects against theft, fire and stale software.
9. **Remote owner view** (daily summary when online) — the feature owners ask about first.
10. **Support plan, hardware kit and installation service** — the reason to choose a local supplier over an app store.

Once you mark the Decision column, I'll fold the chosen items into a v0.3 spec with their phases.

Sources

- [Square Canada review — PayDaddy](#)
- [Loyverse POS review — POSUSA](#)
- [GST/HST invoice requirements — MapleInvoice](#)
- [Uber Eats Marketplace API — getting started](#)
- [DoorDash Marketplace integration requirements](#)

Other rules named here (5¢ cash rounding, Measurement Canada scale approval, BC container deposits, BC meal breaks, 6-year CRA record keeping) are from general knowledge and should be confirmed with an accountant or the relevant agency before launch.